

1

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF SUFFOLK

-----X
DIANE C. DESOUSA and THOMAS E.
DESOUSA,

Plaintiffs,

-against- Index No.:
600371/2021

RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II and
PATRICK J. KARCHER,

Defendants.

-----X

Zoom Meeting

August 10, 2023
12:38 p.m.

EXAMINATION BEFORE TRIAL of the
Plaintiff, DIANE C. DESOUSA, taken by the
Defendants, pursuant to a Notice, held via Zoom
Video Conference before Danielle M. Rivera, a
Notary Public of the State of New York.

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

2

A P P E A R A N C E S:

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DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

3

221. UNIFORM RULES FOR THE
CONDUCT OF DEPOSITIONS

221.1 Objections at Depositions

(a) Objections in general. No objections shall be made at a deposition except those which, pursuant to subdivision (b), (c) or (d) of Rule 3115 of the Civil Practice Law and Rules, would be waived if not interposed, and except in compliance with subdivision (e) of such rule. All objections made at a deposition shall be noted by the officer before whom the deposition is taken, and the answer shall be given and the deposition shall proceed subject to the objections and to the right of a person to apply for appropriate relief pursuant to Article 31 of the CPLR.

(b) Speaking objections restricted. Every objection raised during a deposition shall be stated succinctly and framed so as not to suggest an answer to the deponent and, at the request of the questioning attorney, shall include a clear statement as to any defect in form or other basis of error or irregularity. Except to the extent permitted by CPLR Rule 3115 or by this rule, during the course of the examination persons in attendance shall not make statements or comments that interfere with the questioning.

221.2 Refusal to answer when objection is made. A deponent shall answer all questions at a deposition, except (i) to preserve a privilege or right of confidentiality, (ii) to enforce a limitation set forth in an order of the court, or (iii) when the question is plainly improper and would, if answered, cause significant prejudice to any person. An attorney shall not direct a deponent not to answer except as provided in CPLR Rule 3115 or this subdivision. Any refusal to answer or direction not to answer shall be accompanied by a succinct and clear statement of the basis therefor. If the deponent does not answer a question, the examining party shall have the right to complete the remainder of the deposition.

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

4

221. UNIFORM RULES FOR THE
CONDUCT OF DEPOSITIONS

221.3 Communication with the deponent

An attorney shall not interrupt the deposition for the purpose of communicating with the deponent unless all parties consent or the communication is made for the purpose of determining whether the question should not be answered on the grounds set forth in section 221.2 of these rules and, in such event, the reason for the communication shall be stated for the record succinctly and clearly.

IT IS FURTHER STIPULATED AND AGREED that the transcript may be signed before any Notary Public with the same force and effect as if signed before a clerk or a Judge of the court.

IT IS FURTHER STIPULATED AND AGREED that the examination before trial may be utilized for all purposes as provided by the CPLR.

IT IS FURTHER STIPULATED AND AGREED that all rights provided to all parties by the CPLR cannot be deemed waived and the appropriate sections of the CPLR shall be controlling with respect hereto.

IT IS FURTHER STIPULATED AND AGREED by and between the attorneys for the respective parties hereto that a copy of this examination shall be furnished, without charge, to the attorneys representing the witness testifying herein.

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

5

THE REPORTER: My name is Danielle Rivera. I am a Court Reporter with Realtime Reporting Services and E-Notary Public of the State of New York. Today is Thursday, August 10, 2023 and the time now is 12:38 p.m.

We are here to take the testimony of Diane Desousa via Zoom Video Conference.

Pursuant to New York State Notary Public License Law, Section 135-C, which authorizes any Notary Public to perform an electronic material act by utilizing audio/visual communication, the material act of administering the oath will be recorded.

I have already checked your ID, so I'm going to take this opportunity to swear you in. Please raise your right hand, ma'am.

D I A N E C. D E S O U S A, called as a witness, having been first duly sworn by a Notary Public of the State of New York, was examined and testified as follows:

BY THE REPORTER:

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

6

1 D. DESOUSA

2 Q. Please state your name for the record.

3 A. Diane C. Desousa.

4 Q. What is your address?.

5 A. 329 Grand Central Avenue, Amityville,
6 New York 11701.

7 EXAMINATION BY

8 MS. HAMID:

9 Q. Good afternoon, Mrs. Desousa.

10 A. Hi.

11 Q. How are you?

12 A. Good, good.

13 Q. My name is Nabeela Hamid. I represent
14 the Plaintiff, Calvagno, in this these
15 proceedings. I am going to be asking you a
16 series of questions.

17 Have you ever participated in a
18 deposition before?

19 A. No, first time.

20 Q. Okay. So, just some quick rules. You
21 can take a break any time. Though, if I've
22 asked you a question, I just ask you to answer
23 it. Then, we can take a break.

24 We have to answer verbally so our
25 Court Reporter can note it down, and we will

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

7

1 D. DESOUSA

2 try not to speak over each other so we can have
3 a clear record of the questions asked and your
4 answers today. Okay?

5 A. All right.

6 Q. I know you already gave me your
7 current address, but can you give me your
8 current address again?

9 A. It's 329 Grand Central Avenue.

10 Q. Okay. And are you the owner of the
11 property?

12 A. Yes.

13 Q. Do you own this property with your
14 husband, Thomas Desousa?

15 A. Yes.

16 Q. How long have you lived at this
17 address?

18 A. Approximately twenty-two years.

19 Q. Do you know the owners of the property
20 located at 320 Grand Central Avenue,
21 Amityville?

22 A. Yes, I do.

23 Q. Who owns that property?

24 A. I believe -- I can't pronounce the
25 last name, Richard Cagliano.

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

8

1 D. DESOUSA

2 Q. Calvagno?

3 A. Calvagno.

4 Q. How long have you known Mr. Calvagno?

5 A. I believe he's there about three, four
6 years already; four years, probably.

7 Q. How would you define your relationship
8 with Mr. Calvagno?

9 A. It's not good, not good at all.

10 Q. Okay. So, what I'm going to show you
11 is Defendants' Exhibit E that was previously
12 marked at Mr. Desousa's deposition on May 3rd.
13 Okay (handing)? You can take a look at it.

14 A. Where are my glasses?

15 MR. CUOMO: Do you need them?

16 THE WITNESS: I guess I can do
17 without.

18 MR. CUOMO: Does Tom have them?

19 THE WITNESS: No, he doesn't. I
20 have them at home. I ran out with my
21 sunglasses.

22 MR. CUOMO: Okay. Are they just
23 standard reading glasses?

24 THE WITNESS: Yes -- no, they're not
25 standard. They're prescription.

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

9

1 D. DESOUSA

2 MR. CUOMO: Okay.

3 (Whereupon, the Witness perused the
4 aforementioned document.)

5 Q. Since you've had a chance to look at
6 the document, do you recognize the document?

7 A. What do you mean "recognize"? Like,
8 what went on?

9 Q. Yes.

10 A. Of course I do, yes.

11 Q. Do you know what this document is
12 referred to as?

13 A. A complaint, right?

14 Q. Okay, thank you. If you look at the
15 end, I'm just going to flip it for you; is that
16 your signature?

17 A. Yes.

18 Q. Okay. And it has been notarized?

19 A. Yes.

20 Q. And you understand this document is a
21 sworn statement?

22 A. Yes.

23 Q. All right. I'm going to flip to
24 page 2 for you. So, on page 2, paragraph 9,
25 the allegation asserted by you is, "Upon

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

10

1 D. DESOUSA

2 information and belief, Defendants' Dodge
3 automobile has a modified exhaust system."

4 Have you seen Defendants' Dodge
5 vehicle being modified?

6 A. How would I see it? I've heard it,
7 but I couldn't see it.

8 Q. Okay. What did you hear?

9 A. Like a rocket taking off.

10 Q. Then, on page 3, paragraph 12, you've
11 alleged that, "Upon information and belief,
12 Defendants' operation of his Dodge automobile
13 violates both New York State and Suffolk County
14 Noise Codes."

15 What specific codes are you referring
16 to?

17 A. That, my husband does. I really
18 (indicating).

19 Q. You don't have any knowledge of it?

20 A. No. I know, you know, there is one.
21 It's just, he's the one that looked up the
22 information, not me.

23 Q. Okay. Did you ever call the police
24 regarding these noise issues?

25 A. I believe my husband did, yes.

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

11

1 D. DESOUSA

2 Q. Okay.

3 A. I'm not quite sure of that but --

4 Q. But you, personally, you haven't?

5 A. I haven't, no.

6 Q. Okay. Looking at paragraph 20 on
7 page 4, you've asserted that Defendants'
8 actions create excessive noise and vibrations,
9 which are upsetting to both Plaintiffs causing
10 stomach upset, nausea and manifesting itself in
11 other physical ways as well."

12 Which actions are you referring to?

13 A. Oh, the whole thing. I'm referring to
14 the -- he -- I like to sleep late in the
15 morning. I've raised my children. I've raised
16 my grandchildren. And every morning, it shakes
17 my bed, actually. It's so loud.

18 Q. What shakes your bed?

19 A. His car starting. Because, I guess,
20 the muffler or whatever it is, the exhaust
21 comes right straight across the street and it's
22 so loud. Like I said, it's like a rocket
23 taking off.

24 Then, it still goes on because I can
25 hear him all the way to Merrick Road. As he's

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

12

1 D. DESOUSA

2 going, he's speeding up the block. I've had
3 neighbors asking me, you know, "What's going on
4 every day?"

5 Q. And these actions cause your stomach
6 to be upset and nausea?

7 A. Yes.

8 Q. Have you gone to a physician or a
9 doctor?

10 A. I do have a physician and the doctor.
11 But, I really don't want to get into, you know,
12 talk about my illnesses or whatever.

13 Q. Okay. Which doctor is it that you
14 see?

15 A. Dr. Ben Hurie. H-U-R-I-E, I think.

16 Q. Can you spell it?

17 A. H-U-R-I-E, I think.

18 MR. CUOMO: If you leave a space, we
19 will insert the proper spelling when we
20 get the transcript.

21 MS. HAMID: Yes.

22 _____
23 _____
24 Q. How long have you been seeing this
25 doctor?

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

13

1 D. DESOUSA

2 A. He has been my regular doctor for
3 years.

4 Q. Okay. And you are not taking any
5 medication for the nausea and the upset
6 stomach?

7 A. I take over-the-counter.

8 Q. Over-the-counter, okay. And what do
9 you take over-the-counter?

10 A. Just, like, Pepto, Pepto Bismol.

11 Q. Pepto Bismol?

12 A. Yes.

13 Q. When was the last time you saw your
14 doctor?

15 THE WITNESS: Do we really have to
16 go this far?

17 MR. CUOMO: You have to provide
18 an --

19 THE WITNESS: Okay.

20 A. All right. The last time I saw him
21 was approximately three months ago.

22 Q. Okay. Now, on page 4, paragraph 21,
23 you've stated that "Plaintiffs have stopped
24 taking walks because of the dangers posed by
25 Defendants' reckless driving."

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

14

1 D. DESOUSA

2 When was the last time you took a walk
3 on the street Grand Central Avenue?

4 A. Oh, gosh. Maybe a year and a half
5 ago.

6 Q. A year and a half ago, okay.

7 A. Two, around about that range.

8 Q. Do you do any gardening or yard work
9 in front of your house?

10 A. We used to, no more, though. I
11 stopped.

12 Q. Do you now hire someone to do it and
13 take care of it?

14 A. Yes, someone mows the lawns.

15 Q. Now we're just going to take a look at
16 paragraph 70. In paragraph 70, you have
17 alleged that "The Defendants' conduct and
18 actions have had the intended impact upon the
19 Plaintiffs and have caused them to suffer
20 severe emotional distress."

21 A. Right.

22 Q. When you say "suffer severe emotional
23 distress," are you being treated by a
24 psychiatrist or a psychologist?

25 A. No.

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

15

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D. DESOUSA

Q. Okay. And not any other therapist?

A. No.

MS. HAMID: All right, Ms. Desousa.

Those are all of the questions I have
for you.

THE WITNESS: Okay.

MS. HAMID: Thank you so much.

(Whereupon, at 12:54 p.m., the
Examination of this witness was
concluded.)

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

16

D E C L A R A T I O N

I hereby certify that having been first
duly sworn to testify to the truth, I gave the
above testimony.

I FURTHER CERTIFY that the foregoing
transcript is a true and correct transcript of
the testimony given by me at the time and place
specified hereinbefore.

DIANE C. DESOUSA

Subscribed and sworn to before me
this ____ day of _____ 20__.

NOTARY PUBLIC

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

17

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E X H I B I T S

DEFENDANT EXHIBITS

EXHIBIT NUMBER	EXHIBIT DESCRIPTION	PAGE
(None)		

I N D E X

EXAMINATION BY	PAGE
MS. HAMID	6

INFORMATION AND/OR DOCUMENTS REQUESTED

INFORMATION AND/OR DOCUMENTS	PAGE
Correct spelling of Dr. Ben Hurie	12

QUESTIONS MARKED FOR A RULING

PAGE	LINE	QUESTION
(None)		

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

18

C E R T I F I C A T E

STATE OF NEW YORK)

: SS.:

COUNTY OF NASSAU)

I, DANIELLE M. RIVERA, a Notary Public for
and within the State of New York, do hereby
certify:

That the witness whose examination is
hereinbefore set forth was duly sworn and that
such examination is a true record of the
testimony given by that witness.

I further certify that I am not related to
any of the parties to this action by blood or by
marriage and that I am in no way interested in
the outcome of this matter.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, I have hereunto set my
hand this 10th day of August 2023.

-----
DANIELLE RIVERA

DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

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Witness Name: DIANE C. DESOUSA
Examination Date: August 10, 2023

DIANE C. DESOUSA

Subscribed and sworn to before me
this ____ day of _____, 2023

(Notary Public)

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
 DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

Page 20

A accompanied 3:21 act 5:13,15 action 18:15 actions 11:8,12 12:5 14:18 address 6:4 7:7,8,17 administering 5:15 aforementioned 9:4 afternoon 6:9 against- 1:6 ago 13:21 14:5,6 AGREED 4:9,12,15,18 allegation 9:25 alleged 10:11 14:17 Amityville 6:5 7:21 AND/OR 17:12,13 answer 3:7,11,16,16,20,21 3:21,22 6:22,24 answered 3:19 4:6 answers 7:4 apply 3:8 appropriate 3:9 4:16 approximately 7:18 13:21 Article 3:9 asked 6:22 7:3 asking 6:15 12:3 asserted 9:25 11:7 ASSOCIATES 2:8 attendance 3:14 attorney 2:4 3:12,19 4:4 attorneys 2:9,13 4:19,20 audio/visual 5:14 August 1:11 5:6 18:19 19:3 authorizes 5:12 automobile 10:3,12 Avenue 2:14 6:5 7:9,20 14:3	belief 10:2,11 believe 7:24 8:5 10:25 Ben 12:15 17:14 Bismol 13:10,11 block 12:2 blood 18:15 break 6:21,23 BURSTEIN 2:13 C c 1:3,14 2:2,5 3:4 5:21 6:3 16:2,15 18:2,2 19:3,22 Cagliano 7:25 call 10:23 called 5:21 Calvagno 1:7 2:9 6:14 8:2 8:3,4,8 car 11:19 care 14:13 cause 3:19 12:5 caused 14:19 causing 11:9 Central 6:5 7:9,20 14:3 certify 16:4,8 18:9,14 chance 9:5 charge 4:20 checked 5:17 children 11:15 Civil 3:5 clear 3:12,21 7:3 clearly 4:8 clerk 4:11 codes 10:14,15 comes 11:21 Commack 2:6 comments 3:15 communicating 4:4 communication 4:3,5,7 5:14 complaint 9:13 complete 3:23 compliance 3:6 concluded 15:11	conduct 3:2 4:2 14:17 Conference 1:16 5:9 confidentiality 3:17 consent 4:5 controlling 4:16 copy 4:19 correct 16:9 17:14 County 1:2 10:13 18:5 course 3:14 9:10 court 1:2 3:18 4:11 5:3 6:25 CPLR 3:9,13,20 4:13,15 4:16 create 11:8 CUOMO 2:4,6 8:15,18,22 9:2 12:18 13:17 current 7:7,8 D d 3:4 5:21,21 6:1 7:1 8:1 9:1 10:1 11:1 12:1 13:1 14:1 15:1 16:2 17:8 Dakota 2:10 dangers 13:24 Danielle 1:16 5:2 18:7 Date 19:3 day 12:4 16:19 18:19 19:23 deemed 4:16 defect 3:12 Defendant 2:9,13 17:4 Defendants 1:9,15 Defendants' 8:11 10:2,4,12 11:7 13:25 14:17 define 8:7 deponent 3:11,16,20,22 4:3,5 deposition 3:4,6,7,8,10,17 3:23 4:4 6:18 8:12 Depositions 3:2,3 4:2 DESCRIPTION 17:5 Desousa 1:3,4,14 2:5,5 5:9 6:1,3,9 7:1,14 8:1 9:1 10:1 11:1 12:1 13:1 14:1
B b 3:4,10 17:2 BARBARA 2:8 basis 3:13,22 bed 11:17,18		

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
 DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

Page 21

15:1,4 16:15 19:3,22 Desousa's 8:12 determining 4:6 Diane 1:3,14 2:5 5:9 6:3 16:15 19:3,22 direct 3:20 direction 3:21 distress 14:20,23 doctor 12:9,10,13,25 13:2 13:14 document 9:4,6,6,11,20 DOCUMENTS 17:12,13 Dodge 10:2,4,12 Dr 12:15 17:14 Drive 2:5,10 driving 13:25 duly 5:22 16:5 18:11	far 13:16 Fern 2:5 first 5:22 6:19 16:4 flip 9:15,23 Floor 2:14 follows 5:24 force 4:10 foregoing 16:8 form 3:13 forth 3:18 4:6 18:11 four 8:5,6 framed 3:11 front 14:9 furnished 4:20 further 4:9,12,15,18 16:8 18:14	held 1:15 hereinbefore 16:11 18:11 hereto 4:17,19 hereunto 18:18 Hi 6:10 hire 14:12 home 8:20 house 14:9 Hurie 12:15 17:14 husband 7:14 10:17,25 Hyde 2:10
E	G	I
e 1:3 2:2,2,5 3:6 5:21,21 8:11 16:2 17:2,8 18:2,2 E-Notary 5:4 effect 4:10 electronic 5:13 EMAIL 2:7,11,16 emotional 14:20,22 enforce 3:17 ERRATA 19:2 error 3:13 ESQ 2:4,6,11,15 event 4:7 examination 1:13 3:14 4:13,19 6:7 15:10 17:9 18:10,12 19:3 examined 5:24 examining 3:23 excessive 11:8 exhaust 10:3 11:20 Exhibit 8:11 17:5,5 EXHIBITS 17:4 extent 3:13	gardening 14:8 general 3:3 give 7:7 given 3:7 16:10 18:13 glasses 8:14,23 go 13:16 goes 11:24 going 5:18 6:15 8:10 9:15 9:23 12:2,3 14:15 good 6:9,12,12 8:9,9 gosh 14:4 Grand 6:5 7:9,20 14:3 grandchildren 11:16 grounds 4:6 guess 8:16 11:19	ID 5:17 ii 1:7 2:9 3:17 iii 3:18 illnesses 12:12 impact 14:18 improper 3:18 include 3:12 Index 1:6 indicating 10:18 information 10:2,11,22 17:12,13 insert 12:19 intended 14:18 interested 18:16 interfere 3:15 interposed 3:5 interrupt 4:4 irregularity 3:13 issues 10:24
F	H	J
F 18:2	H 17:2 H-U-R-I-E 12:15,17 half 14:4,6 Hamid 2:11 6:8,13 12:21 15:4,8 17:10 hand 5:20 18:19 handing 8:13 hear 10:8 11:25 heard 10:6	J 1:8 2:14 JASON 2:8 JOHN 2:4,6 johncuomo@gmail.com 2:7 Judge 4:11
		K
		KARCHER 1:8 2:14 know 7:6,19 9:11 10:20,20

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
 DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

Page 22

12:3,11 knowledge 10:19 known 8:4		P 2:2,2 P.C 2:8 p.m 1:11 5:7 15:9 page 9:24,24 10:10 11:7 13:22 17:5,9,13,17 paragraph 9:24 10:10 11:6 13:22 14:16,16 Park 2:10 participated 6:17 parties 4:5,15,19 18:15 party 3:23 PATRICK 1:8 2:14 Pepto 13:10,10,11 perform 5:12 permitted 3:13 person 3:8,19 personally 11:4 persons 3:14 perused 9:3 Pg 19:5 physical 11:11 physician 12:8,10 place 16:10 plainly 3:18 Plaintiff 1:14 6:14 Plaintiffs 1:5 2:4 11:9 13:23 14:19 Please 5:19 6:2 police 10:23 posed 13:24 Practice 3:5 prejudice 3:19 prescription 8:25 PRESENT 2:16 preserve 3:17 previously 8:11 privilege 3:17 probably 8:6 proceed 3:8 proceedings 6:15 pronounce 7:24 proper 12:19 property 7:11,13,19,23
	N	
	N 2:2,4,6 5:21 16:2 17:8 Nabeela 2:11 6:13 name 5:2 6:2,13 7:25 19:3 NASSAU 18:5 nausea 11:10 12:6 13:5 need 8:15 neighbors 12:3 New 1:2,17 2:6,10,10,15 2:15 5:5,10,23 6:6 10:13 18:3,8 nhamid@longislandlitig... 2:11 noise 10:14,24 11:8 notarized 9:18 Notary 1:17 4:10 5:10,12 5:23 16:22 18:7 19:25 note 6:25 noted 3:7 Notice 1:15 NUMBER 17:5	
	O	
	O 5:21 16:2 oath 5:15 objection 3:10,16 objections 3:3,3,3,6,8,10 officer 3:7 Oh 11:13 14:4 okay 6:20 7:4,10 8:10,13 8:22 9:2,14,18 10:8,23 11:2,6 12:13 13:4,8,19,22 14:6 15:2,7 operation 10:12 opportunity 5:18 order 3:18 outcome 18:17 over-the-counter 13:7,8,9 owner 7:10 owners 7:19 owns 7:23	
	P	
L 16:2 late 11:14 LAVAIA 2:15 Law 3:5 5:11 lawns 14:14 leave 12:18 Lexington 2:14 License 5:11 limitation 3:18 LINE 17:17 lived 7:16 LLP 2:13 Ln 19:5 located 7:20 long 7:16 8:4 12:24 look 8:13 9:5,14 14:15 looked 10:21 Looking 11:6 loud 11:17,22		
	M	
M 1:16 2:8 18:7 ma'am 5:20 manifesting 11:10 MARC 2:15 marked 8:12 17:16 marriage 18:16 material 5:13,14 matter 18:17 mean 9:7 medication 13:5 Meeting 1:10 Merrick 11:25 Mlavaia@wbny.com 2:16 modified 10:3,5 months 13:21 morning 11:15,16 mows 14:14 muffler 11:20		

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
 DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

Page 23

provide 13:17 provided 3:20 4:13,15 psychiatrist 14:24 psychologist 14:24 Public 1:17 4:10 5:5,11,12 5:23 16:22 18:7 19:25 purpose 4:4,5 purposes 4:13 pursuant 1:15 3:4,9 5:10 Q question 3:18,22 4:6 6:22 17:17 questioning 3:12,15 questions 3:16 6:16 7:3 15:5 17:16 quick 6:20 quite 11:3 R R 2:2 16:2 18:2 raise 5:19 raised 3:10 11:15,15 ran 8:20 range 14:7 Read 19:5 reading 8:23 Reads 19:5 really 10:17 12:11 13:15 Realtime 5:4 reason 4:7 19:5 reckless 13:25 recognize 9:6,7 record 4:8 6:2 7:3 18:12 recorded 5:16 referred 9:12 referring 10:15 11:12,13 refusal 3:16,21 regarding 10:24 regular 13:2 related 18:14 relationship 8:7 relief 3:9 remainder 3:23	Reporter 5:2,3,25 6:25 Reporting 5:4 represent 6:13 representing 4:20 request 3:12 REQUESTED 17:12 respect 4:17 respective 4:19 restricted 3:10 Richard 1:7 2:9 7:25 right 3:8,17,23 5:19 7:5 9:13,23 11:21 13:20 14:21 15:4 rights 4:15 Rivera 1:16 5:3 18:7 Road 11:25 rocket 10:9 11:22 rule 3:4,6,13,14,20 rules 3:2,5 4:2,7 6:20 RULING 17:16 S S 2:2 5:21,21 17:2 saw 13:13,20 section 4:6 5:11 sections 4:16 see 10:6,7 12:14 seeing 12:24 seen 10:4 series 6:16 Services 5:4 set 3:18 4:6 18:11,18 severe 14:20,22 shakes 11:16,18 SHEET 19:2 show 8:10 signature 9:16 signed 4:10,11 significant 3:19 sleep 11:14 space 12:18 speak 7:2 Speaking 3:10	specific 10:15 specified 16:11 speeding 12:2 spell 12:16 spelling 12:19 17:14 SS 18:4 standard 8:23,25 starting 11:19 state 1:2,17 5:5,10,23 6:2 10:13 18:3,8 stated 3:11 4:7 13:23 statement 3:12,22 9:21 statements 3:15 STIPULATED 4:9,12,15 4:18 stomach 11:10 12:5 13:6 stopped 13:23 14:11 straight 11:21 street 11:21 14:3 subdivision 3:4,6,20 subject 3:8 Subscribed 16:18 19:23 succinct 3:21 succinctly 3:11 4:8 suffer 14:19,22 Suffolk 1:2 10:13 suggest 3:11 Suite 2:10 sunglasses 8:21 SUPREME 1:2 sure 11:3 swear 5:19 sworn 5:22 9:21 16:5,18 18:11 19:23 system 10:3 T T 16:2 17:2 18:2,2 take 5:8,18 6:21,23 8:13 13:7,9 14:13,15 taken 1:14 3:7 talk 12:12 testified 5:24
---	---	--

DIANE C. and THOMAS E. DESOUSA v. RICHARD A. CALVAGNO II, et al.
 DIANE C. DESOUSA - August 10, 2023

Page 24

testify 16:5	walk 14:2	2 9:24,24
testifying 4:20	walks 13:24	20 11:6 16:19
testimony 5:8 16:6,10	want 12:11	2023 1:11 5:6 18:19 19:3
18:13	WARSHAW 2:13	19:23
thank 9:14 15:8	way 11:25 18:16	21 13:22
therapist 15:2	ways 11:11	221 3:2 4:2
therefor 3:22	we're 14:15	221.1 3:3
thing 11:13	went 9:8	221.2 3:16 4:7
think 12:15,17	WHEREOF 18:18	221.3 4:3
Thomas 1:3 2:5 7:14	witness 4:20 5:22 8:16,19	
three 8:5 13:21	8:24 9:3 13:15,19 15:7,10	3
Thursday 5:6	18:10,13,18 19:3	3 2:10 10:10
time 5:7 6:19,21 13:13,20	work 14:8	300 2:10
14:2 16:10		31 3:9
today 5:5 7:4	X	3115 3:5,13,20
Tom 8:18	X 1:3,9 17:2,8	320 7:20
transcript 4:10 12:20 16:9	Y	329 6:5 7:9
16:9 19:2		3rd 8:12
treated 14:23	yard 14:8	
trial 1:13 4:13	year 14:4,6	4
true 16:9 18:12	years 7:18 8:6,6 13:3	4 11:7 13:22
truth 16:5	York 1:2,17 2:6,10,15,15	
try 7:2	5:5,10,23 6:6 10:13 18:3	5
twenty-two 7:18	18:8	575 2:14
Two 14:7		
U	Z	6
U 5:21	Zoom 1:10,15 5:9	6 17:10
understand 9:20	0	600371/2021 1:6
UNIFORM 3:2 4:2	1	7
upset 11:10 12:6 13:5	10 1:11 5:6 19:3	70 14:16,16
upsetting 11:9	10002 2:15	7th 2:14
utilized 4:13	10th 18:19	
utilizing 5:13	11 2:5	8
V	11042 2:10	9
vehicle 10:5	11701 6:6	9 9:24
verbally 6:24	11725 2:6	
vibrations 11:8	12 10:10 17:14	
Video 1:16 5:9	12:38 1:11 5:7	
violates 10:13	12:54 15:9	
W	135-C 5:11	
waived 3:5 4:16	2	